

UniVerse Impact - Global Privacy Policy

Last Updated: September 29, 2026

UniVerse Impact ("we," "our," or "us") is deeply committed to protecting your privacy and ensuring the security of your personal data globally. This Privacy Policy outlines our practices regarding the collection, use, sharing, and safeguarding of personal information processed through the UniVerse Impact platform at universeimpact.com (the "Platform").

This policy has been designed to comply with global privacy frameworks, including but not limited to:

- The European Union General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) and UK GDPR.
- The California Consumer Privacy Act (CCPA) and California Privacy Rights Act (CPRA), USA.
- The Digital Personal Data Protection Act (DPDPA), India.
- The Lei Geral de Proteção de Dados (LGPD), Brazil.

1. Data Controller and Joint Controllership

UniVerse Impact acts as the primary Data Controller (or Data Fiduciary under the DPDPA) for the personal data processed through the Platform regarding user registration, platform security, and core functionality.

Where an educational institution ("Institution") deploys the Platform for its students, faculty, and staff, UniVerse Impact and the Institution act as Joint Controllers or UniVerse Impact acts as a Data Processor on behalf of the Institution, depending on the specific data processing context (e.g., official academic records, grading).

Contact the Global Data Protection Officer (DPO): Email: privacy@universeimpact.com

2. Categories of Personal Data We Collect

We collect and process the following categories of personal data globally:

2.1 Account and Identity Data

- Full name, Email address, Phone number (if phone authentication is utilized).
- Profile avatar or photograph (provided directly or via Google/Apple Single Sign-On).
- Account Role (Student, Teacher, Administrator, NGO Representative, Industry Mentor).
- Account status, timestamps of login events, and administrative audit logs.
- Sign-in details: the device and browser used, IP address, and approximate location (city and country) derived from the IP address, shown to you in your sign-in history for security.
- Staff applications: if you apply for a Teacher or NGO Representative account, your institution, job title, a link to a staff page or profile, and any proof document you upload (such as a staff ID card or appointment letter). These are reviewed only by administrators.

2.2 Academic and Institutional Data

- Course enrollments and historical academic trajectories.
- Attendance records (Present, Absent, Late, Excused).
- Grades, quiz submissions, and calculated scores.
- Timetable scheduling, elective preferences, and major change requests.
- Uploaded academic documents, certificates, and assignments.

2.3 Student Profile, Career, and Impact Data

- Institution-specific identifiers (Student ID, department, year of study, GPA).
- Declared skills, career profiles, and resumes.
- Internship and job applications submitted through the Platform.
- Proof-of-work submissions, NGO project applications, and summit registrations.
- Calculated Impact XP score, progression level, and blockchain-anchored Impact Credentials.

2.4 Special Category / Sensitive Personal Data

Certain data is considered "special category" (GDPR) or "sensitive personal data" (DPDPA/CCPA) and requires heightened protection:

- **Medical Records:** Health information entered voluntarily via the Medical module, including blood type, allergies, chronic conditions, regular medications, and emergency contacts.
- **Consent Management:** Digitally signed consents regarding institutional activities or data processing.
- **Safety Reports (BeeSafe):** Contextual descriptions of incidents reported via the BeeSafe campus security module.

2.5 Financial and Billing Data

- Records of payments generated for tuition, exams, library, and activity fees (including amount, type, and transaction status).
- Invoice history and generated receipts.

Note: UniVerse Impact does not collect, process, or store full credit card numbers. All payment processing is handled exclusively by our PCI-DSS compliant partner, Stripe.

2.6 Communications and Interaction Data

- Contents of direct messages sent in private conversations and group chats, including photos, files, and voice notes.
- Call history (who called whom, when, and for how long). Calls themselves are not recorded.
- Whiteboards you create or edit, including drawings and photos added to them.
- Public or semi-public group posts, knowledge hub articles, and announcements.
- Notes, feedback, and scheduling data from mentorship sessions and collaborative projects.
- Content you enter into AI features, such as questions to the study assistant and documents you ask us to summarize.

2.7 Technical and Usage Data

- IP address, browser type, operating system, and device information.
- Pages visited, feature utilization metrics, and interaction timestamps.
- Push notification subscription tokens.
- Diagnostic error logs and system performance monitoring data.

3. Purposes and Legal Bases for Processing

We process your personal data relying on the following legal bases across global jurisdictions:

Data Category	Primary Purpose	Legal Basis (Global Mapping)
Account & Identity	Provisioning access, securing the account, and delivering core functionality.	Contract Performance (GDPR Art 6.1b) / Consent & Legitimate Purpose (DPDPA) / Business Purpose (CCPA)
Academic Records	Fulfilling educational management obligations requested by the Institution.	Contract & Legitimate Interests (GDPR Art 6.1b, 6.1f) / Institutional Purpose (DPDPA)
Medical Records	Safeguarding student health; providing critical data to medical staff in emergencies.	Explicit Consent & Vital Interests (GDPR Art 9.2a, 9.2c) / Explicit Consent (DPDPA, CCPA)
Financial Data	Processing mandated institutional fees and maintaining financial records.	Contract & Legal Obligation (GDPR Art 6.1b, 6.1c) / Lawful Purpose (DPDPA)
BeeSafe Reports	Ensuring campus physical security and routing rapid incident response.	Legitimate & Vital Interests (GDPR Art 6.1f, 6.1d) / Public Interest (DPDPA)
AI Matching & AI Features	Generating tailored project/internship recommendations and answering requests made to AI features.	Legitimate Interests (GDPR Art 6.1f) / Business Purpose (CCPA)
Technical Data	Monitoring system health, preventing fraud, and optimizing the platform infrastructure.	Legitimate Interests (GDPR Art 6.1f) / Security Purpose (CCPA)
Marketing Comms.	Sending promotional emails regarding new features or partner opportunities.	Consent (GDPR Art 6.1a, DPDPA) / Opt-in Right (CCPA) – Revocable at any time

4. How We Use Your Data

We process your data strictly to:

1. Provide, maintain, and continuously improve the Platform and its modules.
2. Authenticate your identity and maintain rigorous security perimeters.
3. Enable academic workflows, including grading, attendance, and timetabling for your Institution.

4. Power the AI Skill-to-Project Matching Engine, utilizing your skills and academic history to surface highly relevant NGO projects and internships, and answer requests you make to AI features (see section 5.3).
5. Issue, cryptographically hash, and verify blockchain-anchored Impact Credentials.
6. Facilitate payment processing and generate associated billing receipts via Stripe.
7. Route critical safety alerts (BeeSafe) directly to authorized campus administrators.
8. Deliver in-app notifications, announcements, and strictly necessary administrative emails.
9. Generate anonymized and aggregated analytics for institutional reporting and platform research.
10. Detect abuse, mitigate fraud, and investigate security threats via comprehensive audit logging.

We unequivocally do not sell your personal data to third parties, nor do we utilize your personal data for third-party cross-context behavioral advertising (as defined under CCPA).

5. Data Sharing and Disclosures

To deliver our services, we may share your data with the following categories of recipients:

5.1 Your Educational Institution

Administrators, teachers, and authorized staff at your Institution possess access to your academic, attendance, grade, financial, and relevant profile data as necessary to conduct institutional operations and fulfill educational mandates.

5.2 NGOs, Companies, and External Partners

When you actively submit an application for an NGO project, internship, startup showcase, or summit through the Platform, your relevant profile information (name, skills, career profile, contact details) is shared directly with the respective external organization.

5.3 Authorized Third-Party Subprocessors

We utilize industry-leading technology partners bound by strict Data Processing Agreements (DPAs):

- **Google LLC (Firebase Authentication):** Authentication and identity infrastructure.
- **Google LLC (Gemini API):** AI features. The text you enter into the study assistant, documents you ask us to summarize, and data included in AI impact reports are sent to Google to produce a response.
- **Cloudflare, Inc.:** Hosting and serverless computing (Workers), database (D1), file storage (R2), and real-time features.
- **Stripe, Inc.:** PCI-compliant payment processing.
- **Resend, Inc.:** Delivery of notification and account emails.
- **8x8, Inc. (Jitsi Meet):** Voice and video calls started from chats. Call audio and video pass through Jitsi's servers.
- **Polygon public blockchain:** A fingerprint (hash) of each Impact Credential is recorded on this public network so anyone can verify it. No names or other personal details are written to the blockchain.

5.4 Legal Authorities

We may disclose your data if legally mandated by a court order, subpoena, or statutory obligation globally, or if such disclosure is strictly necessary to protect the vital interests, safety, or rights of any person.

5.5 Platform Administration

Authorized UniVerse Impact personnel and your Institution's administrators can access account data, including private messages, call history, uploaded documents, and activity records, where necessary to operate and secure the Platform, moderate content, investigate reports of abuse or safety concerns, respond to legal requests, or act on your own support request. Such access is restricted to authorized staff, and administrative actions are recorded in an audit log.

5.6 Content You Share

When you share a whiteboard, document, or post, the people you share it with can see it. If you turn on link sharing for a whiteboard, any User who has the link can view (or, if you choose, edit) it. You can turn link sharing off at any time.

6. Blockchain and Impact Credentials

When an Impact Credential is successfully issued to you upon project completion, the Platform generates a SHA-256 cryptographic hash of the core credential payload (comprising your name, project title, issuance date, and institution). This hash is formatted as a W3C Verifiable Credential v1.1 and may be anchored on the Polygon public blockchain. Only the hash is recorded there; it cannot be turned back into your name or other details.

- **Public Verification:** The public verification endpoint (e.g., `/verify/[id]`) enables third parties to verify the authenticity of your credential. If you do not wish for your credential to be publicly verifiable, do not distribute the verification link.
- **Immutability and Erasure:** Blockchain cryptographic hashes are, by definition, immutable records. Deleting a hash from the underlying audit chain would permanently compromise the mathematical integrity of all subsequent verifications. While the hash itself cannot be "deleted," upon receiving a valid request for erasure (under GDPR, CCPA, or DPDPA), we will immediately suppress the public display and accessibility of your credential through our interfaces.

7. Medical and Special Category Data Protection

Any medical information (e.g., blood type, allergies) provided via the Medical module is classified as special category or sensitive personal data globally.

- **Consent:** This data is processed exclusively on the basis of your explicit, affirmative, and verifiable consent. You may revoke this consent and remove this data at any time from the Medical section of the Platform, or by contacting privacy@universeimpact.com.
- **Access Control:** Medical data is protected by strict Role-Based Access Control (RBAC). It is accessible only to you, designated medical personnel at your Institution, and authorized

administrators in the event of an emergency. It is never shared with third-party NGOs or corporate partners.

8. Data Retention Periods

We retain your personal data only for as long as necessary to fulfill the purposes outlined in this Policy, or as required by global laws:

Data Type	Standard Retention Period
Account Data	Until account deletion + 30-day grace period.
Academic Records	Duration of institutional enrollment + 5 to 7 years (per legal/academic compliance globally).
Payment Records	7 years (to comply with international tax and accounting laws).
Audit & Security Logs	2 years.
Medical Records	Until consent is withdrawn or the account is deleted, whichever occurs first.
Communications	Until account deletion or until the conversation is explicitly deleted by participants.
Staff Application Documents	Until the application is decided, and for up to 12 months afterwards.
Credential Hashes	Indefinite (necessary for blockchain integrity; public display is suppressed upon request).
Technical / Log Data (including sign-in history)	90 days.

9. Your Global Data Protection Rights

Depending on your jurisdiction (including the EU, UK, USA/California, India, Brazil, etc.), you possess specific rights regarding your personal data:

- **Right of Access / Right to Know:** Request a comprehensive copy of the personal data we hold about you and details on how it is processed.
- **Right to Rectification / Correction:** Request correction of inaccurate, obsolete, or incomplete data.
- **Right to Erasure / Deletion ("Right to be Forgotten"):** Request the deletion of your personal data where no overriding legal obligation requires its retention.
- **Right to Restrict Processing:** Request a temporary halt to the processing of your data under specific conditions.
- **Right to Data Portability:** Receive a copy of your data in a structured, commonly used, machine-readable format (e.g., JSON export).

- **Right to Object / Opt-Out:** Object to processing based on legitimate interests, including the generation of AI-based recommendations, and opt-out of any marketing communications. (Under CCPA, you have the right to opt out of the "sale" or "sharing" of personal data, though we do not engage in such practices).
- **Right to Non-Discrimination:** You will not receive discriminatory treatment for exercising your privacy rights.
- **Right to Withdraw Consent:** Revoke consent previously granted for medical data processing or marketing communications.
- **Right to Lodge a Complaint:** File a formal complaint with your national or state Data Protection Authority (e.g., CNIL, ICO, California Privacy Protection Agency, Data Protection Board of India).

To exercise any of these rights, please submit a written request to privacy@universeimpact.com. We will process and respond to your request within the timeframe mandated by your local law (typically 30-45 days).

10. Cookies and Tracking Technologies

The Platform relies minimally on client-side storage to function securely:

- **Essential Cookies:** Required for session management, Firebase authentication token handling, and Cross-Site Request Forgery (CSRF) protection. These cannot be disabled.
- **Local Storage:** Utilized to cache authentication tokens, user interface preferences (e.g., dark mode), and temporary state to improve performance.
- **Push Tokens:** Stored only if you explicitly grant the browser permission to receive push notifications.

We do not utilize tracking cookies, advertising pixels, or third-party behavioral analytics trackers.

11. Data Security

We implement robust technical and organizational security measures globally to protect your data against unauthorized access, alteration, disclosure, or destruction:

- **Encryption:** HTTPS/TLS encryption for all data in transit; encryption at rest for the database (Cloudflare D1) and stored files (Cloudflare R2).
- **Authentication:** Industry-standard OAuth 2.0 and JWT-based identity management via Firebase.
- **Access Control:** Strict Role-Based Access Controls (RBAC) ensuring data is only visible to appropriately credentialed roles.
- **Breach Notification:** In the event of a personal data breach posing a risk to your rights and freedoms, we will notify you and the competent supervisory authorities globally in accordance with statutory timelines (e.g., within 72 hours under GDPR, as promptly as possible under DPDPA/CCPA).

12. International Data Transfers

As a globally accessible platform, we may process and store data in the United States, Europe, India, and other global regions through the subprocessors listed in section 5.3.

Any transfer of personal data across international borders is safeguarded by:

- **Standard Contractual Clauses (SCCs):** Approved by the European Commission for EU-US transfers, or equivalent clauses approved by the UK ICO and Swiss FDPIC.
- **Data Protection Frameworks:** Compliance with recognized international data transfer frameworks where certified by our sub-processors.
- **Local Data Localization Laws:** Where strictly required by national law (e.g., specific sectoral mandates in India), we architect data storage to comply with local localization requirements.

13. Children's Privacy

The Platform is not directed at children under the age of 16 (or under 18 in specific jurisdictions like India where the age of digital consent is higher). We do not knowingly collect personal data from anyone under the age of digital consent without documented, verified parental or guardian consent. If we become aware that a child under the applicable age has provided personal data without such consent, we will take immediate steps to delete the information.

14. Changes to This Privacy Policy

We may update this Privacy Policy periodically to reflect changes in our global practices or legal requirements. Material changes will be communicated to Users via an in-platform announcement or an email to Institution administrators at least fourteen (14) days prior to the changes taking effect. The "Last Updated" date at the top of this document reflects the most recent revision.

15. Contact Us

If you have questions, concerns, or wish to exercise your data protection rights globally, please contact our privacy team:

UniVerse Impact — Privacy & Data Protection Team

Email: privacy@universeimpact.com

Legal Department: legal@universeimpact.com

Website: universeimpact.com

Grievance Officer (India): For complaints under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act or other Indian law, email privacy@universeimpact.com with the subject "Grievance". We acknowledge complaints within 24 hours and resolve them within 15 days.